France (:)

H1 2026 Gambling Market & Regulatory Brief · Published 15 Oct 2026 · Currency EUR (tables in € millions unless stated; ~US$ at EUR/USD 1.1212, 15 Oct 2026)

CONFIDENTIAL · INTERNAL
Prepared: 19 Oct 2026
B2Tech · via Merlin

THE ONE-LINE VERDICT

France's regulated market stalled in H1 2026: GGR excluding casinos rose just 0.5% to €5.66bn (~$6.35bn) as the two exclusive-rights monopolies (FDJ United lottery/retail, PMU horse racing) shrank and only the competitive online segment grew (+11% to €1.45bn / ~$1.62bn, now 25.6% of the market). The online growth is real but World Cup-loaded and bonus-fuelled (June stakes +47%, acquisition bonuses ×4, bonuses now 13.8% of online GGR) inside the heaviest tax regime in Europe (59.3% of GGR on online sports betting since 1 July 2025) and a regulator explicitly pushing for a "less intensive" model — a market for scale operators with disciplined CAC, not for opportunistic entrants.

MARKET GGR EXCL. CASINOS (H1-26)	ONLINE GGR (SPORTS, POKER, HORSE)	ONLINE SPORTS BETTING STAKES / GGR	ONLINE ACTIVE ACCOUNTS (CJA)	ONLINE BONUSES PAID	PMU EXCLUSIVE-RIGHTS GGR
€5.66bn (~$6.35bn)	**€1.45bn (~$1.62bn)**	**€6.62bn / €995m**	**5.85m**	**€199m (~$223m)**	**€782m (~$877m)**
+0.5% YoY (vs +4.1% in H1-25)	+11.0% YoY; 25.6% of market (+2.4pt)	+10.6% / +11.6%; hold 15.0%	+24% YoY; unique players 4.06m (+17%)	+28%; 13.8% of online GGR (11.9%)	-5.8% YoY; 3rd consecutive decline

1 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **Growth has stalled at the market level.** The ANJ's semi-annual review (published 15 Oct 2026) puts H1 2026 GGR (PBJ) excluding land-based casinos and Paris gaming clubs at €5.66bn (~$6.35bn), +0.5% YoY versus +4.1% in H1 2025. Casinos (€2.82bn / ~$3.16bn GGR in FY2025, +3.4%) are reported annually only, so the full-market run-rate is ~€14bn+ (FY2025: €14.1bn / ~$15.8bn, +3.0%).
- **Online is the only growth engine.** Online GGR (sports betting, poker, horse racing — the only three products open to competition) rose 11.0% to €1,449m (~$1,625m), contributing +2.5pt to market growth, while FDJ United's exclusive-rights activities subtracted 1.2pt and PMU 0.8pt. Online penetration of the ex-casino market reached 25.6% (+2.4pt); on the FY2025 all-in base online was 18.5% (12.8% in 2019).
- **Market structure remains a two-monopoly-plus-online model.** FDJ United's exclusive rights (lottery retail+online, retail sports betting) generated €3,429m (~$3,845m), 61% of ex-casino GGR; PMU's exclusive rights (pari-mutuel horse racing) €782m (~$877m), 13.8% share (15.8% in H1 2024); online sports betting €995m (~$1,116m), 17.6%; online poker €290m (~$325m); online horse racing €164m (~$184m).
- **Sports betting growth was a June/World Cup event, not a trend.** Online sports stakes rose 10.6% to €6.62bn (~$7.42bn) and GGR 11.6% to €995m, but stakes grew only +4% in Jan–May versus +47% in June (€1,327m / ~$1,488m, 20% of the half's handle). Monthly active accounts rose +2% to +11% YoY in Jan–May, then +69% in June (3.14m). The ANJ itself frames H2 as the test of whether the World Cup durably widened the bettor pool.
- **Promotional intensity is escalating faster than revenue.** Total online bonuses reached €199m (~$223m), +28% — 2.5× online GGR growth — and 13.8% of online GGR (11.9% a year earlier). Sports betting bonuses were €129m (~$145m, +35%; 12.9% of GGR vs 10.7%; ~1.9% of stakes); June alone absorbed €35.5m (vs €14.5m) and acquisition bonuses nearly quadrupled (€9.0m vs €2.4m). Poker was the exception: bonuses +11% (€50.9m) with acquisition spend −15%.
- **Player base at a record, but monetisation per account is falling.** Online active accounts hit 5.85m (+24%) and unique players 4.06m (+17%); accounts per player rose from 1.37 to 1.44 and segments per player from 1.38 to 1.45 — players are spreading across more operators. Sports stakes per active account fell 14% (~€1,270), average bet slipped from €14.6 to €14.0, poker GGR per account fell 18% (€153→€126), horse racing GGR per account −3.7% (€312→€300).
- **Poker is back in growth; horse racing online is volume-up, margin-down.** Poker GGR +13.4% to €290m, driven by Sit&Go (€202m, 70% of GGR; short formats +15.9%), with active accounts +38.5% to 2.3m — poker players are now 44% of all online unique players (38%). Online horse-race stakes rose 15.8% to €920m (~$1,032m), the strongest since 2021 and evenly spread across months, but GGR grew only 2.8% as hold fell from 20.1% to 17.8%.
- **The monopolies are shrinking.** FDJ United's French exclusive-rights GGR fell 2.0% (−€69m), of which lottery −€64m (−2.1% to €2,979m / ~$3,340m; draw games −7.6% on fewer/lower EuroMillions jackpots and heatwave-hit retail footfall; +1% ex long EuroMillions cycles per the operator). Retail sports betting fell 1.1% to €450m (~$505m). PMU's stakes fell 3.8% to €3,096m (~$3,471m) and GGR 5.8% — a third straight decline, accelerating from −2.6% — with the stakes/GGR gap partly explained by PMU lifting the retail Simple bet RTP from 83.6% to 84.6% in Oct 2025.
- **Licensing is a closed, three-product regime.** The ANJ (created 1 Jan 2020 under Ordinance 2019-1015, replacing ARJEL) licenses only online sports betting, online horse-race betting and online 'jeux de cercle' (poker). Each agrément is product-specific, granted for 5 years, renewable, non-transferable, and requires an EU/EEA seat. Fees are nominal (CGI art. 1012 / annex III art. 313 BR): €5k/€8k/€10k application for 1/2/3 licences and €20k/€30k/€40k annual. Online casino (slots, roulette, blackjack) remains illegal.
- **Operator landscape: 16 licensed entities, with a visible wave of new entrants.** The ANJ register lists 16 licensees: 16 with sports betting, 5 with horse racing (Betclic, FDJ United's Unibet/Zeturf, Genybet, bet365, PMU) and 7 with poker (bwin/partypoker, Betclic, Unibet, bet365, PMU, PokerStars, Winamax). bet365.fr, betsson.fr, daznbet.fr, circusbet.fr and yesorno-jeu.fr are recent additions; FDJ United has unified its French online brands under Unibet. The ANJ does not publish operator market shares (n/a).
- **Taxation is GGR-based and the heaviest in Europe, and it was raised on 1 July 2025 (LFSS 2025).** Online sports betting: 59.3% of GGR (33.7% state levy, CGI 302 bis ZH; 15.0% social levy, up from 10.6%; 10.6% national sports agency levy, CGI 1609 tricies), from 54.9%. Retail sports betting 42.1% (from 41.1%). Online poker: social levy moved from 0.2% of stakes to 10% of GGR. Online horse racing

(incl. return to racing companies): 52.9% (from 52.3%). Lottery: 69% on jackpot draw games (from 68%), 56.5% on other draw/instant games (from 55.5%). FDJ United quantified the full-year hit at ~€90m revenue/EBITDA.

- **Tax take is large and visible in operator accounts.** FDJ United reported €2,613m (~$2,930m) of public levies on €4,314m of group GGR in H1 2026 (+0.7% despite GGR −1.3%), and €52m of H1 revenue lost to 2025–26 tax increases (3pt of revenue growth). On the ANJ's online sports betting GGR of €995m, the 59.3% all-in rate implies ~€590m (~$662m) of H1 public levies [estimate]. Player winnings are untaxed online; land-based casino winnings above €1,500 bear a 13.7% social levy.
- **Enforcement is active and expanding to new formats.** Since gaining administrative blocking powers (March 2022) the ANJ had blocked 1,337 illegal sites by late 2025, and in July 2026 obtained blocking of Polymarket, Stake and Cbet. The ANJ/PwC study sized illegal online GGR at €748m–€1.5bn (~$839m–$1,682m), 5–11% of the market; the industry lobby AFJEL's Nov 2025 barometer claims 5.4m players and €2bn (~$2.2bn) GGR — treat as advocacy, not regulator data.
- **Responsible-gambling pressure is the dominant regulatory vector.** In May 2026 the ANJ published (Decision 2026-118) an algorithm to identify excessive/pathological players, stating ~600,000 online players show a high probability of excessive play, and expects operators to identify and support more of them. A July 2026 sanctions-commission decision (2026-031) addressed an operator's failures on excessive players, including bonus restrictions. The ANJ chair's FY2025 message was blunt: all indicators are 'red' and the framework needs adapting toward a less intensive model.
- **Advertising is pre-controlled, not just policed.** Operators must submit annual promotional strategies and annual excessive-gambling action plans for ANJ approval (e.g., Decision 2026-016 for PMU), commercial communications are governed by Decree 2020-1349 with mandatory health warnings, and the ANJ can order withdrawal of ads. The 2023 influencer law restricts gambling promotion to age-gated platforms [framework not re-verified this session]. June's bonus surge shows the regime does not yet cap bonuses — a plausible next step.
- **Payments are conventional and KYC-heavy.** Licensed operators run verified player accounts with mandatory self-set deposit and stake limits at account opening; withdrawals must go to a payment account in the player's name; cards and bank transfers dominate, crypto is not accepted by licensees [payments detail not re-verified this session — n/a for method shares].
- **Online casino legalisation is stalled.** A PLF 2025 amendment (Oct 2024) proposing a 55.6%-of-GGR tax on online casino was withdrawn within days under land-based casino pressure; the Bercy consultation launched Nov 2024 has not resumed and no bill was on the 2026 agenda. A March 2026 IGF report reportedly favours a conditional opening [unverified]. Expect the debate to recur in the PLF/PLFSS 2027 cycle; nothing before 2027 at the earliest.
- **Structural adjacencies:** Paris gaming clubs (FY2025 GGR €97m / ~$109m, −21% after two months' closure) were made permanent after an eight-year experiment; the JONUM (monetisable digital objects / Web3 games) experimental framework took effect early 2026; the ANJ's 14 Oct 2026 note on 2025 online sports betting linked niche football leagues to excessive bettors — a signal that content restrictions ('liste sport') may tighten.
- **Operator read-through for B2Tech.** France is a large, low-growth, high-tax, high-compliance market where the addressable (competitive) pool is ~€2.9bn annualised online GGR, growing ~9–11%, split among 16 licensees with escalating bonus inflation. Entry is cheap on fees but expensive on marketing and margin (59.3% levy leaves ~€0.41 of each GGR euro before costs). The investable thesis is scale and CAC discipline in sports/poker; horse racing is a niche with eroding hold; online casino is not an option; and the political direction (tax, RG, advertising) is uniformly tighter.

2 MARKET SUMMARY

€ M (~US$ M) — ANJ H1 2026 REPORT; FY2025 ANJ ANNUAL REVIEW	H1 2026	YOY	H1 2025	FY 2025
GGR (PBJ) BY SEGMENT				
Total market excl. casinos & gaming clubs H1 2025 implied from ANJ growth rates; ANJ restated online perimeter in 2025, so H1-25 comparatives differ from the 2025 semi-annual report.	**5,660 (~$6,346)**	**+0.5%**	**~5,632**	**~11,190 (14,100 incl. casinos/clubs, +3.0%)**
FDJ United — exclusive rights in France (lottery + retail sports betting)	3,429 (~$3,845)	-2.0%	3,498	6,950 (49.2% of total)
of which lottery (retail + online)	2,979 (~$3,340)	-2.1% (draw games -7.6%)	3,043	n/a
of which retail sports betting	450 (~$505)	-1.1%	455	n/a
PMU — exclusive rights (pari-mutuel horse racing)	782 (~$877)	-5.8%	830	1,651 (-2.8%)
Online competitive market (3 products)	**1,449 (~$1,625)**	**+11.0%**	**1,307**	**2,617 (+8.6%)**
Online sports betting	995 (~$1,116)	+11.6%	892	1,766 (+10.4%)
Online poker	290 (~$325)	+13.4%	256	525 (+6.5%)
Online horse-race betting	164 (~$184)	+2.8%	160	326 (+2.4%)
Land-based casinos (reported annually)	n/a	n/a	n/a	2,816 (~$3,157), +3.4%; 31.6m entries
Paris gaming clubs (reported annually)	n/a	n/a	n/a	97 (~$109), -21%
CHANNEL & PLAYER KPIS				
Online share of GGR excl. casinos	25.6%	+2.4pt	23.2%	18.5% of total incl. casinos
Online active player accounts (CJA)	5.85m	+24%	4.7m	6.1m (+7.1%)
Online unique players (JU)	4.06m	+17%	3.5m	4.2m (+7.7%)
Accounts per player / segments per player	1.44 / 1.45	+0.07 / +0.07	1.37 / 1.38	n/a
Online bonuses paid to players	199 (~$223)	+28%	~155	n/a
Bonuses as % of online GGR	13.8%	+1.9pt	11.9%	n/a
TAX REGIME (BASE = GGR/PBJ; RATES IN FORCE SINCE 1 JUL 2025, LFSS 2025)				
Online sports betting — all-in public levies	59.3% of GGR	+4.4pt	54.9%	33.7% state + 15.0% social + 10.6% sport agency
Retail sports betting (FDJ monopoly)	42.1% of GGR	+1.0pt	41.1%	social levy 6.6%→7.6%
Online horse-race betting (incl. return to racing companies)	52.9% of GGR	+0.6pt	52.3%	social levy unchanged; racing fee set by decree
Online poker	10% of GGR (social levy)	from 0.2% of stakes	0.2% of stakes	state levy on stakes [unverified]
Lottery — jackpot draw games / other draw & instant	69% / 56.5% of GGR	+1.0pt each	68% / 55.5%	CSG 6.2%→7.2%
Implied public levies on online sports betting GGR [estimate] ANJ GGR × statutory all-in rate; not a reported figure.	~590 (~$662)	n/a	~490 (blended)	~1,010 (blended)
FDJ United group public levies (reported) 60.6% of FDJ United group GGR of €4,314m; mostly French lottery.	2,613 (~$2,930)	+0.7%	2,595	n/a
LICENSING				
Licensed online entities (ANJ register, Oct 2026)	16	n/a	n/a	16 sports / 5 horse / 7 poker licences
Licence fees (CGI art. 1012; annex III art. 313 BR)	€5k/€8k/€10k application (1/2/3 products)	n/a	n/a	€20k/€30k/€40k annual; 5-year term, renewable

3 DEEP-DIVE — ONLINE SPORTS BETTING

> **+11.6% GGR to €995m, but a June/World Cup spike (stakes +47%) bought with a near-quadrupling of acquisition bonuses; Jan–May stakes grew only 4%.**

STAKES, GGR AND HOLD

GGR rose 11.6% to €995m on stakes +10.6% to €6,616m, but the half was uneven and June/World Cup drove the spike.

- Hold was 15.0% (14.9% in H1 2025, 15.2% in H1 2024), swinging from 20.3% in January and May to 11.4% in February and 12.2% in June.
- June stakes were €1,327m (~$1,488m), 20% of the half's handle, versus a Jan–May run-rate of ~€1,060m a month; Jan–May stakes grew only 4%.
- Q1 stakes €3,192m, Q2 €3,425m; FDJ United separately reported 'high' player-return rates on the tournament.
- Segment contributed 7.9 of the 11 points of online GGR growth and holds 68.6% of online GGR.

PLAYER RECRUITMENT

Player data point to a recruitment surge rather than deepening engagement; a majority of event-recruited accounts are expected to churn within two quarters.

- Active accounts +28% to 5.2m, unique players +21% to 3.6m; monthly active accounts grew +2% to +11% Jan–May before +69% in June to 3.14m.
- Stakes per active account fell 14% to roughly €1,270; average bet slipped from €14.6 to €14.0 (€17.4 to €14.7 in June); ~469m bets.
- Accounts per player rose to 1.43, consistent with newer entrants (bet365, Betsson, DAZN Bet, Circus) prying open multi-accounting.
- ANJ's caveat that H2 activity will show whether the pool has durably widened is the right one.

PROMOTIONAL SPEND

Bonuses reached €129m (~$145m), +35%, or 12.9% of GGR, and are the structural concern for operator unit economics.

- Bonus ratio was 10.7% a year earlier; bonuses equal ~1.9% of stakes.
- June bonuses €35.5m (28% of the half) against €14.5m in June 2025; acquisition bonuses, down 6% Jan–May, nearly quadrupled in June (€9.0m vs €2.4m).
- With public levies at 59.3% of GGR, a 12.9% bonus ratio leaves roughly 28% of GGR for all other costs before margin.
- The market is being competed on CAC, not product; a 15.0%-hold month like January can mask this, a 12% June cannot.

PRODUCT MIX

Football took 55.8% of stakes (53.1%), +16% over the half, while tennis stagnated and 'other sports' was the only organic diversification signal.

- Football +116% in June and only +2.5% Jan–May; excluding June its share slipped (54% vs 55%).
- Tennis +2% Jan–May, −13.5% in June, share down from 26.0% to 23.2%.
- Basketball 8.5% (9.1%), rugby 1.6% (1.9%), other sports 11.0% (10.0%) with stakes +21%.
- Live betting share flat at 50% Jan–May but fell from 54% to 44% in June as pre-match volume dominated.

REGULATORY READ-THROUGH

Bonus restrictions are the most probable near-term rule change; FY2026 segment GGR of roughly €1.95–2.0bn is a peak-cycle base, not a trend line.

- ANJ note on 2025 online sports betting linked niche football leagues to excessive bettors; its May 2026 excessive-player algorithm is now with operators.
- Bonus-driven World Cup, 13% bonus/GGR ratio and a regulator asking for a 'less intensive' model point to restrictions via promotional-strategy approval if not decree.
- Operators should assume promotional headroom narrows from 2027.
- FY2026 estimate: FY2025 €1,766m plus H1 growth and a July World Cup final (~$2.2bn).

ONLINE SPORTS BETTING — € M (~US$ M); ANJ H1 2026 REPORT INCL. MONTHLY ANNEX	H1 2026	YOY	H1 2025	H1 2024
VOLUME & MARGIN				
Stakes (handle)	**6,616 (~$7,418)**	**+10.6%**	**5,984**	**5,200**
GGR (PBJ)	**995 (~$1,116)**	**+11.6%**	**892**	**792**
Hold (GGR / stakes)	15.0%	+0.1pt	14.9%	15.2%
Monthly hold range (Jan–Jun 2026) Jan 20.3%, Feb 11.4%, Mar 12.7%, Apr 13.8%, May 20.3%, Jun 12.2%.	11.4%–20.3%	n/a	n/a	n/a
Stakes Jan–May YoY / June YoY	+4% / +47%	n/a	n/a	n/a
June stakes	1,327 (~$1,488)	+47%	~903	n/a
Number of bets	~469m	n/a	n/a	n/a
PLAYERS				
Active accounts (CJA)	5.2m	+28%	4.1m	3.7m
Unique players (JU)	3.6m	+21%	3.0m	2.7m
June monthly active accounts	3.14m	+69%	~1.86m	n/a
Accounts per player	1.43	+0.08	1.35	1.34
Stakes per active account	~€1,270	-14%	~€1,460	n/a
Average bet (H1 / June)	€14.0 / €14.7	-4% / -16%	€14.6 / €17.4	n/a
PROMOTIONS				
Bonuses paid	129 (~$145)	+35%	~96	n/a
Bonuses % of GGR / % of stakes	12.9% / 1.9%	+2.2pt / +0.3pt	10.7% / 1.6%	n/a
June bonuses (total / acquisition)	35.5 / 9.0	+145% / ×3.75	14.5 / 2.4	n/a
Acquisition bonuses Jan–May YoY	-6%	n/a	n/a	n/a
MIX				
Football share of stakes	55.8%	+2.7pt	53.1%	n/a
Tennis share of stakes	23.2%	-2.8pt	26.0%	n/a
Basketball / Rugby / Other	8.5% / 1.6% / 11.0%	-0.6 / -0.3 / +1.0pt	9.1% / 1.9% / 10.0%	n/a
Live share of stakes (Jan–May / June)	50% / 44%	0 / -10pt	50% / 54%	n/a

4 DEEP-DIVE — ONLINE POKER & ONLINE HORSE-RACE BETTING

Poker returned to double-digit growth (+13.4%) on Sit&Go and a 38% jump in accounts; horse racing online posted its best stakes growth since 2021 (+15.8%) but hold fell to 17.8%.

POKER REVENUE

Online poker GGR reached €290m (~$325m), +13.4%, after a flat H1 2025 (−0.4%), driven almost entirely by short formats.

- Sit&Go generated €202m, 70% of segment GGR; Sit&Go plus MTT rose 15.9% to €240m (83% of GGR); cash game ~€50m (+2.8% after −14%).
- Sit&Go GGR accelerated: +5–10% YoY in Q1, ~+20% April–May, ~+30% June, suggesting World Cup cross-sell rather than a poker-native revival.
- Poker contributed 2.6 points of online growth; share of online GGR recovered to 20.0% (19.6%).

POKER PLAYERS AND BONUSES

Poker's player base grew far faster than revenue, with active accounts +38.5% to 2.3m, and growth was not bonus-led.

- Unique players +34.4% to 1.8m, three times H1 2025 rates; monthly accounts +16% Jan–Feb, 21–29% Mar–May, 62% June.
- GGR per active account fell 18% from €153 to €126; poker players are 44% of all online unique players (38%).
- Bonuses rose 11% to €50.9m (17.6% of GGR), acquisition bonuses fell 15%, bonus per account dropped from €27 to €22.
- Seven operators hold poker licences; liquidity is ring-fenced to France apart from shared-liquidity arrangements permitted since 2018.

POKER TAX CHANGE

From 1 July 2025 the social levy moved from 0.2% of stakes to 10% of GGR, making H1 2026 the first half fully under the new base.

- Growth of +13.4% despite this suggests operators have not passed the cost through in rake; margin absorption is not visible in ANJ data.
- Industry argued the change created a competitive distortion versus land-based casinos, whose social levies rose only 0.7pt.
- Against the illegal online casino market (ANJ/PwC: €748m–€1.5bn GGR) it widens the pricing gap further.

ONLINE HORSE-RACE BETTING

Stakes rose 15.8% to €920m (~$1,032m), the strongest since 2021, but GGR grew only 2.8% to €164m as hold fell to 17.8%.

- Prior growth +6% in H1 2024, +1% in H1 2025; every month up 13–20% YoY with no June peak.
- Hold fell from 20.1% to 17.8%, mirroring PMU's retail RTP increase and pointing to price competition for the same pari-mutuel pools.
- Active accounts +6.8% to 547k, unique players +3.2% to 462k; GGR per account −3.7% to €300.
- Galop stakes +18.2% to €456m, trot +13.5% to €464m; trot ~60% in Jan–Feb, galop ~55% Mar–May.
- Bonuses +36% to €19.7m, 12.0% of GGR (9.1%), 96% retention.

COMMERCIAL IMPLICATION

Online horse racing is a scale-and-content niche taking share from PMU's network; poker is the more interesting adjacency for a sportsbook-led entrant.

- Online now 23% of horse-race stakes vs 20% a year earlier, with five licensees (Betclic, Unibet/Zeturf, Genybet, bet365, PMU) competing on returns.
- Pool economics are set by the racing companies' levy; public levies incl. racing return ~52.9% of GGR per FDJ United.
- Poker is growing, under-bonused and benefits from cross-sell, but the 10%-of-GGR social levy plus the state poker levy [rate unverified] set a hard floor on rake.

ONLINE POKER & HORSE RACING — € M (~US$ M); ANJ H1 2026 REPORT	H1 2026	YOY	H1 2025	H1 2024
ONLINE POKER				
GGR (PBJ)	**290 (~$325)**	**+13.4%**	**256**	**257**
Sit&Go GGR (share of segment)	202 (70%)	~+17%	n/a	n/a
Sit&Go + MTT GGR	240	+15.9%	207	202
Cash game GGR	~50	+2.8%	49	55
Active accounts (CJA)	2.3m	+38.5%	1.7m	1.5m
Unique players (JU)	1.8m	+34.4%	1.3m	1.2m
GGR per active account	€126	-18%	€153	n/a
Bonuses paid / % of GGR	50.9 (~$57) / 17.6%	+11% / -0.4pt	~45.9 / 17.9%	n/a
Acquisition bonuses YoY / bonus per CJA	-15% / €22	n/a	€27	n/a
Tax: social levy base & rate (since 1 Jul 2025)	10% of GGR	from 0.2% of stakes	0.2% of stakes	0.2% of stakes
ONLINE HORSE-RACE BETTING				
Stakes	**920 (~$1,032)**	**+15.8%**	**795**	**787**
GGR (PBJ)	**164 (~$184)**	**+2.8%**	**160**	**160**
Hold (GGR / stakes)	17.8%	-2.3pt	20.1%	20.3%
Galop stakes / Trot stakes	456 / 464	+18.2% / +13.5%	~386 / ~409	n/a
Active accounts (CJA)	547k	+6.8%	513k	497k
Unique players (JU)	462k	+3.2%	447k	433k
GGR per active account	€300	-3.7%	€312	n/a
Bonuses paid / % of GGR (96% retention)	19.7 (~$22) / 12.0%	+36% / +2.9pt	~14.5 / 9.1%	n/a
Online share of total horse-race stakes (vs PMU network)	~23%	+3pt	~20%	n/a
All-in public levies incl. racing return (FDJ United)	52.9% of GGR	+0.6pt	52.3%	52.3%

5 DEEP-DIVE — EXCLUSIVE-RIGHTS OPERATORS: FDJ UNITED (LOTTERY & RETAIL SPORTS BETTING) AND PMU (HORSE RACING)

The monopolies that still hold 75% of ex-casino GGR both contracted — FDJ United −2.0% on a weak EuroMillions cycle and heatwaves, PMU −5.8% in a third straight year of decline.

FDJ UNITED FRENCH GGR

FDJ United's exclusive-rights GGR fell 2.0% (−€69m) to €3,429m (~$3,845m) on a weak EuroMillions cycle and heatwaves.

- Lottery accounted for €64m of the decline (−2.1% to €2,979m); draw games fell 7.6%; excluding long EuroMillions cycles (jackpots above €75m) lottery GGR rose 1%.
- Retail sports betting fell 1.1% to €450m (~$505m) with Q2 improving on a more attractive offer.
- Group GGR €4,314m (−1.3%); public levies €2,613m (+0.7%); net gaming revenue €1,701m (−4.1%); revenue €1,782m (−4.5%), €52m (3pt) lost to 2025–26 tax increases.

FDJ PROFITABILITY AND GUIDANCE

Recurring EBITDA fell 8.4% to €404m (22.7% margin) and FDJ United guides to stable FY2026 GGR and a 23–24% EBITDA margin.

- Recurring operating profit −15.1% to €229m; net result swung from €136m profit to €16m loss on €135m impairments plus a €20m exceptional contribution.
- Net debt stable at €1,964m; Moody's reaffirmed Baa1.
- Guidance: low-single-digit revenue decline, dividend payout of at least 75% of adjusted net income, review of online markets and non-core payments assets.
- Online BU GGR flat at €702m; excluding the Netherlands and UK, GGR grew 6.6% 'notably' on France; FDJ United is 61% of ex-casino GGR.

PMU STRUCTURAL RETREAT

PMU stakes fell 3.8% to €3,096m and GGR −5.8% to €782m, a third consecutive decline, as PMU buys volume defence with margin.

- Prior declines −2% (H1 2024) and −4.2% (H1 2025); stakes €264m (−7.9%) below two years ago; Q1 −3.9%, Q2 −3.7%.
- GGR acceleration concentrated in Q2 (−5.7% vs −1.3%); network GGR down €70m (−8.2%) in two years.
- Retail Simple bet RTP raised from 83.6% to 84.6% from October 2025.
- Share of ex-casino market fell to 13.8% (15.8% H1 2024, 14.7% H1 2025); online sports betting is 3.8 points ahead; horse-race stakes share slipped from 80% to 77%.

RACING GOVERNANCE AND FUNDING

2026 is a transition year with new leadership and a 'Pacte PMU 2030', while budget support for racing fell 9.6% to €725m.

- Cyrille Giraudat became CEO in January 2026; Éric Woerth appointed chair on 30 March 2026.
- 2026 budget provides €725m (~$813m) versus €802m in 2025; FY2025 stakes −3.3% to €6.4bn, GGR −2.8% to €1,651m, players −5.7% to 3.3m.
- Racing companies' levy on online horse-race betting is set annually by decree and can rise to compensate the filière.
- PMU's political weight makes liberalisation of pari-mutuel exclusivity improbable.

LAND-BASED CASINOS

FY2025 casino GGR was €2,816m (+3.4%) and the sector's opposition to iGaming legalisation is undiminished.

- 31.6m entries (+2%); Paris gaming clubs, made permanent after eight years, posted €97m (−21%) after a two-month closure.
- Successful October 2024 lobbying against the online-casino amendment; any future opening likely designed around land-based licence holders.
- The ANJ itself has advocated a 'highly controlled' approach.

FDJ UNITED & PMU — € M (~US$ M); ANJ H1 2026 REPORT, FDJ UNITED H1 2026 RELEASE, ANJ FY2025 REVIEW	H1 2026	YOY	H1 2025	FY 2025
FDJ UNITED				
GGR — exclusive rights in France (lottery + retail SB)	**3,429 (~$3,845)**	**-2.0%**	**3,498**	**6,950 (+2.8%)**
Lottery GGR (retail + online)	2,979 (~$3,340)	-2.1%	3,043	n/a (+3.4%)
Draw games GGR growth	n/a	-7.6%	n/a	n/a
Retail sports betting GGR	450 (~$505)	-1.1%	455	n/a
Group GGR (incl. Kindred, international lottery)	4,314 (~$4,837)	-1.3%	4,369	8,706
Group public levies	2,613 (~$2,930)	+0.7%	2,595	n/a
Group revenue	1,782 (~$1,998)	-4.5%	1,866	n/a
Recurring EBITDA (margin)	404 (22.7%)	-8.4%	441 (23.6%)	FY26 target 23–24%
Net result €135m impairments on online B&G intangibles (NL, UK, Romania) + €20m exceptional corporate contribution.	-16	n/m	+136	n/a
Online B&G BU GGR (group)	702	-0.2%	703	n/a
Net financial debt	1,964	flat	1,964	n/a
PMU (EXCLUSIVE RIGHTS)				
Stakes	**3,096 (~$3,471)**	**-3.8%**	**3,219**	**6,400 (-3.3%)**
GGR (PBJ)	**782 (~$877)**	**-5.8%**	**830**	**1,651 (-2.8%)**
Hold (GGR / stakes)	25.3%	-0.5pt	25.8%	25.8%
Quarterly stakes YoY (Q1 / Q2)	-3.9% / -3.7%	n/a	-5.5% / -3.0%	n/a
Retail Simple bet RTP	84.6%	+1.0pt (Oct 2025)	83.6%	n/a
Share of ex-casino market GGR	13.8%	-0.9pt	14.7%	15.8% in H1 2024
PMU network share of horse-race stakes	77%	-3pt	80%	n/a
Return to horse-racing industry (budget)	725 FY26 (~$813)	-9.6%	n/a	802 (~$899)
Players (unique)	n/a	n/a	n/a	3.3m (-5.7%)
LAND-BASED (ANNUAL ONLY)				
Casinos GGR / entries	n/a	n/a	n/a	2,816 (~$3,157), +3.4% / 31.6m
Paris gaming clubs GGR	n/a	n/a	n/a	97 (~$109), -21%

6 DEEP-DIVE — LICENSING, TAXATION & OPERATOR LANDSCAPE

Cheap to license, brutal to tax: 16 licensees compete for three online products under a 59.3%-of-GGR regime for sports betting that was raised in July 2025 and sits in a budget cycle hunting for revenue.

LEGAL ARCHITECTURE

Law 2010-476 opened three online products to competition and Ordinance 2019-1015 created the ANJ from 1 Jan 2020 over the whole sector.

- ANJ oversees online licensees, FDJ (25-year exclusivity under the 2019 PACTE privatisation), PMU, and land-based casinos for responsible-gambling and advertising.
- Everything not expressly authorised is prohibited: online casino, online bingo and betting exchanges remain illegal, policed via administrative blocking.

LICENSING TERMS

Licences are per product, five-year, renewable, EU/EEA-only, with trivial fees; the real cost of entry is operating compliance.

- Fees: €5,000 / €8,000 / €10,000 at application for one / two / three categories and €20,000 / €30,000 / €40,000 a year.
- Requires a cahier des charges, certified platform with ANJ-accessible archiving (the 'frontal'), and player-protection obligations.
- Ongoing: monthly levy declarations, ANJ pre-approval of promotional strategy and excessive-gambling plan, AML, five-yearly renewal (Zeturf 14 May 2024; PMU June 2025).

OPERATOR LANDSCAPE

The ANJ register (October 2026) lists 16 licensees, with international brands arriving since 2024 and buying trial via bonuses.

- All 16 hold sports-betting licences; five hold horse-race licences; seven hold poker licences.
- New entrants: bet365.fr, betsson.fr, daznbet.fr, circusbet.fr plus niche brands; FDJ United unified French online brands under Unibet after absorbing Kindred.
- Trade consensus places Winamax, Betclic and Unibet as sports-betting leaders [unverified]; accounts-per-player rose 1.37→1.44.

TAXATION

Online sports betting bears an all-in public take of 59.3% of GGR, the highest headline rate in Europe, raised in July 2025.

- Components: 33.7% state levy, 15.0% social levy (raised from 10.6% by LFSS 2025 art. 32), 10.6% Agence nationale du sport levy.
- Retail sports betting 42.1% (41.1%), online horse racing 52.9% (52.3%), poker 10%-of-GGR social levy, lottery 69% on jackpot draws and 56.5% on other games (+1pt each).
- Online winnings untaxed; land-based casino winnings above €1,500 bear 13.7%; amendments extending that to betting and lottery (~€200m a year) tabled, not adopted.
- Operators also pay corporate income tax and, for FDJ United in 2026, the exceptional contribution on large-company profits.

MARGIN STACK AND OUTLOOK

Levies imply ~€590m public take on €995m sports GGR, leaving roughly €0.28 of each GGR euro before marketing media and overhead; only scale survives.

- ~€405m left for the licensed sector before bonuses (€129m), payment, platform, content and staff costs.
- FDJ United quantified the 1 July 2025 increases at ~€45m in 2025 and ~€90m in a full year, offset only by 2027; AFJEL warned of smaller-licensee exits.
- No exits yet, but bonus inflation and hold compression in horse racing have appeared.
- PLFSS/PLF 2027 debates this autumn are the next window for levy or winnings-tax changes — the key regulatory swing factor for FY2027 planning.

LICENSING & TAX PARAMETERS (BASE = GGR/PBJ UNLESS STATED)	CURRENT (SINCE 1 JUL 2025)	BASE	PRE-1 JUL 2025	LEGAL REFERENCE / NOTE
PUBLIC LEVIES BY VERTICAL				
Online sports betting — all-in	**59.3%**	**GGR**	**54.9%**	**33.7% state (CGI 302 bis ZH) + 15.0% social (CSS L137-21) + 10.6% sport agency (CGI 1609 tricies)**
Retail sports betting (FDJ monopoly)	42.1%	GGR	41.1%	social levy 6.6%→7.6%; sport agency levy 6.6%
Online horse-race betting (incl. return to racing cos.)	52.9%	GGR	52.3%	social levy unchanged (6.9%); racing fee by annual decree (FDJ United disclosure)
Online poker — social levy	10%	GGR	0.2% of stakes	LFSS 2025; state levy on stakes [unverified]
Lottery — jackpot draw games (Loto, EuroMillions)	69%	GGR	68%	CSG 6.2%→7.2%
Lottery — other draw & instant games	56.5%	GGR	55.5%	CSG 6.2%→7.2%
Land-based casinos	progressive levy + social (+0.7pt)	GGR	n/a	scale [unverified]; winnings >€1,500 taxed 13.7%
Player winnings — online betting/poker	0%	n/a	0%	extension of 13.7% levy proposed in PLF amendments, not adopted
LICENSING				
Licensable online products	3 (sports, horse racing, poker)	n/a	3	online casino, bingo, exchanges prohibited
Licence term / transferability	5 years, renewable	n/a	5 years	non-transferable; EU/EEA seat required
Application fee (1 / 2 / 3 products)	€5k / €8k / €10k (~$5.6k / $9.0k / $11.2k)	n/a	same	CGI annex III art. 313 BR
Annual fee (1 / 2 / 3 products)	€20k / €30k / €40k (~$22k / $34k / $45k)	n/a	same	CGI art. 1012
Licensed entities (ANJ register)	16	n/a	n/a	16 sports / 5 horse racing / 7 poker
Exclusive rights	FDJ (lottery; retail SB, 25 yrs from 2019); PMU (retail pari-mutuel)	n/a	same	PACTE law 2019; Law 2010-476
Implied H1 2026 levies, online sports betting [estimate]	~€590m (~$662m)	GGR €995m × 59.3%	n/a	not a reported figure

7 DEEP-DIVE — ENFORCEMENT, RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING, ADVERTISING, PAYMENTS & THE ONLINE-CASINO QUESTION

The ANJ is tightening on every axis — blocking (1,337 sites, now Polymarket/Stake), an excessive-player algorithm flagging ~600k accounts, sanctions tied to bonuses — while online casino legalisation stays frozen.

ILLEGAL MARKET ENFORCEMENT

The ANJ has blocked 1,337 illegal sites and in July 2026 blocked Polymarket, Stake and Cbet; the illegal market is dominated by online casino.

- Administrative blocking and de-listing powers obtained March 2022.
- ANJ/PwC sizes the illegal market at €748m–€1.5bn GGR, 5–11% of the total market.
- AFJEL claims 5.4m players, €2bn illegal GGR and €1.2bn foregone tax; these are advocacy figures and should be weighted accordingly.
- Channelisation in sports betting and poker is high, while slot/casino demand leaks entirely offshore.

RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING

Decision 2026-118 gave operators an excessive-player algorithm flagging ~600,000 players, ~15% of 4.06m unique players, with sanctions now tied to bonuses.

- Operators must identify numbers 'consistent with the size of their player pool', contact, impose moderators, refer to support and close accounts as last resort.
- Sanctions Decision 2026-031 (10 July 2026) fined an operator; remedies include ceasing monthly loyalty bonuses to excessive players — first explicit bonus-sanction link.
- Hard rules: mandatory deposit and stake limits, self-exclusion register (~86,000 people in 2025), credit bans, annual ANJ-approved action plans, 'Evalujeu'.

ADVERTISING CONTROLS

Advertising is pre-controlled via Decree 2020-1349 and annual ANJ promotional-strategy approval; we expect 2027 approvals to constrain bonus volumes.

- Rules: no targeting of minors, no association with social or financial success, mandatory health warnings; 2023 influencer law confines promotion to age-gated platforms.
- H1 2026 data: acquisition bonuses nearly quadrupled in June, total online bonuses 13.8% of GGR; ANJ warned 41% of French World Cup viewers intended to bet.
- Chair's call for 'adaptations to the regulatory framework' expected to become a bonus cap or a ban on bonuses for flagged players.

PAYMENTS

Payments are conventional: verified single accounts, withdrawals to own-name accounts, no credit or crypto; friction is KYC and AML, not acceptance.

- Deposits by bank card, transfer and regulated e-wallets/prepaid vouchers; method shares not published by the ANJ.
- No mobile-money layer as in African markets; AML reporting to TRACFIN.
- Online betting and poker winnings untaxed in players' hands, supporting channelisation.

ONLINE CASINO QUESTION

Online casino legalisation stays frozen; the earliest realistic vehicle is the 2027 budget, with land-based licence holders structurally advantaged.

- October 2024 PLF 2025 amendment proposed a 55.6%-of-GGR tax and was withdrawn within about ten days after land-based casinos mobilised.
- Bercy consultation held one plenary in November 2024 and has not resumed; ANJ confirmed suspension as of April 2026; no bill scheduled for 2026.
- A March 2026 IGF report is said to favour a conditional Belgian-style opening [unverified].
- JONUM experimental regime took effect early 2026 and Paris gaming clubs were made permanent; neither offers a route to online slots.

ENFORCEMENT, RG AND PERIMETER INDICATORS	VALUE	PERIOD	SOURCE TYPE	NOTE
ILLEGAL ONLINE MARKET				
Illegal online GGR (ANJ/PwC study)	€748m–€1.5bn (~$839m–$1,682m)	2023	regulator study	5–11% of total market; mostly online casino
Illegal players / GGR (AFJEL barometer)	5.4m / €2bn (~$2.2bn)	2025	industry lobby	advocacy figure; claims €1.2bn tax loss
Illegal sites blocked (cumulative)	1,337	to late 2025	ANJ brochure	administrative blocking since Mar 2022
2026 blocking orders	Polymarket, Stake, Cbet	Jul 2026	trade press	prediction markets treated as unlicensed betting
RESPONSIBLE GAMBLING				
Players flagged as likely excessive by ANJ algorithm	~600,000	May 2026	ANJ Decision 2026-118	≈15% of 4.06m online unique players
Self-exclusion register	~86,000	2025	ANJ brochure	approximate (OCR)
Sanctions precedent on excessive players / bonuses	Decision 2026-031	10 Jul 2026	ANJ sanctions commission	operator ceased monthly loyalty bonuses to excessive players
Mandatory player tools	deposit & stake limits at sign-up; moderators; self-exclusion	in force	Law 2010-476 & decrees	no credit; account in player's name
ADVERTISING				
Framework	Decree 2020-1349; ANJ-approved annual promotional strategies	in force	legislation / ANJ	health warnings mandatory; ANJ can order withdrawal
Online bonuses (all products)	€199m (~$223m); 13.8% of GGR	H1 2026	ANJ report	+28% YoY; June acquisition bonuses ×~4
PERIMETER				
Online casino status	illegal; consultation suspended	Oct 2026	ANJ / press	PLF 2025 amendment (55.6% GGR) withdrawn Oct 2024
JONUM (Web3 games) experimental regime	in force	early 2026	ANJ FY2025 review	adjacent, not gambling
Paris gaming clubs	made permanent	2026	ANJ FY2025 review	FY2025 GGR €97m (-21%)

8 HIGHLIGHTS & LOWLIGHTS

▲ HIGHLIGHTS

- Competitive online pool is large and still compounding: €1,449m (~$1,625m) GGR in H1 2026, +11% (vs +8.2% in H1 2025), on an FY2025 base of €2,617m; with all three products growing for the first time in several years, FY2026 online GGR of ~€2.85–2.9bn (~$3.2bn) is plausible [estimate]. structural
- Record and diversifying player base: 5.85m active accounts (+24%) and 4.06m unique players (+17%), with accounts-per-player up to 1.44 — new brands can win trial, as bet365, Betsson and DAZN Bet have shown since 2025. mixed
- Poker is an under-bonused growth adjacency: GGR +13.4% with acquisition bonuses −15%, Sit&Go accelerating to ~+30% YoY by June and poker players now 44% of online uniques — cross-sell economics favour a sportsbook-plus-poker licence pair. structural
- Monopoly erosion creates share: PMU's share fell to 13.8% (15.8% two years ago) and online horse-race stakes +15.8% are migrating pari-mutuel volume to licensed online books; FDJ retail sports betting (−1.1%) continues to lose relative ground to online. structural
- Licensing cost is negligible and the perimeter is legally clear: €5–10k application, €20–40k annual, 5-year renewable agréments, no local-ownership or server-location mandates beyond an EU/EEA seat and ANJ-accessible archiving. structural
- High channelisation in licensed products: untaxed player winnings, a 1,337-site blocking record and the July 2026 Polymarket/Stake orders keep sports and poker demand onshore, limiting black-market price competition in those verticals. structural
- World Cup 2026 showed the market still responds to events: June stakes +47%, 3.14m monthly actives (+69%), FDJ United group tournament stakes >€700m — the H2 retention data (FY report ~April 2027) will tell operators the true event ROI. one-off

▼ LOWLIGHTS

- Highest tax burden in Europe and rising: 59.3% of GGR on online sports betting since 1 July 2025 (from 54.9%), poker social levy now 10% of GGR, and gambling has become a recurring revenue line in a strained budget cycle — PLFSS/PLF 2027 is a live risk for further increases or a winnings tax. structural
- Bonus inflation is outrunning revenue: online bonuses +28% to €199m, 13.8% of GGR; sports bonuses 12.9% of GGR and acquisition spend ×~4 in June — a CAC war among 16 licensees on a 41%-of-GGR net base. watch
- Growth is event-dependent and per-account monetisation is falling: Jan–May sports stakes only +4%; stakes per active account −14%; poker GGR per account −18%; horse-racing hold down 2.3pt to 17.8%. mixed
- Regulatory direction is uniformly restrictive: ANJ algorithm flags ~600k excessive players (~15% of uniques), a July 2026 sanction tied remedies to bonus withdrawal, the chair calls for a 'less intensive' model, and the Oct 2026 niche-leagues note points to tighter content rules — expect bonus caps and marketing constraints from the 2027 promotional-strategy cycle. governance
- No online casino, and no credible path before 2027: the 2024 amendment was withdrawn, the Bercy consultation is dormant, land-based casinos (FY2025 GGR €2.8bn, +3.4%) remain opposed — the ~€0.75–1.5bn (regulator) to €2bn (industry) of casino demand stays offshore. structural
- Monopoly incumbents are also the best-capitalised competitors: FDJ United (61% of ex-casino GGR, €1.96bn net debt, Baa1) runs Unibet in the open market and PMU holds all three online licences; both have political weight in setting racing levies and content lists. structural
- Horse racing economics are deteriorating for everyone: online hold fell from 20.1% to 17.8%, PMU raised retail RTP by 1pt, the racing industry's funding was cut 9.6% to €725m — pressure to raise the racing companies' levy (set by decree) on online operators is the likely response. watch

9 FORECAST & OUTLOOK

Guidance bridge. The market bridge from H1 2025 to H1 2026 is simple and uncomfortable: headline growth fell from +4.1% to +0.5% because the two exclusive-rights operators swung from contributing +2.7pt (FDJ United alone, H1 2025) to subtracting 2.0pt combined (FDJ United −1.2pt on a weak EuroMillions cycle and heatwaves; PMU −0.8pt on a structural, accelerating decline), while the competitive online segment lifted its contribution to +2.5pt (sports betting +11.6%, poker +13.4%, horse racing +2.8%) — but with a June that supplied most of the sports growth on a near-quadrupling of acquisition bonuses. FY2025 context: the full market grew 3.0% to €14.1bn (~$15.8bn) with online at 18.5%; FDJ United now guides to flat FY2026 French-network GGR and the ANJ flags that full-year online growth depends on post-World Cup retention of a record 5.85m active accounts.

H1 2025 MARKET GROWTH (EXCL. CASINOS)	ONLINE SEGMENT CONTRIBUTION, H1 2026	FDJ UNITED EXCLUSIVE RIGHTS	PMU EXCLUSIVE RIGHTS → H1 2026 MARKET GROWTH
+4.1%	**+2.5pt**	**-1.2pt**	**-0.8pt → +0.5%**
FDJ United contributed +2.7pt	sports +7.9pt, poker +2.6pt, horse +0.3pt of online's +11%	lottery -€64m (draw games -7.6%); retail SB -1.1%	PMU GGR -5.8%, stakes -3.8%

Independent view. Market: we expect FY2026 ex-casino GGR of roughly €11.2–11.4bn (~$12.6–12.8bn), flat to +1% [estimate], with FDJ United's H2 lottery promotional push offsetting PMU's continued −3% to −5% slide, and online GGR of ~€2.85–2.9bn (+9–11%) [estimate] as the July World Cup final adds to Q3 before a tougher Q4 comparison; online penetration should end 2026 above 26% of the ex-casino market and above 20% all-in. **Margins:** the 59.3% levy is fixed for 2026 but operator economics will be squeezed by bonus inflation (we expect bonuses to stay above 13% of online GGR for the year) and by hold normalisation after an unusually strong January/May; expect at least one smaller licensee to exit or be acquired within 18 months, and consolidation around Winamax, Betclic, Unibet/FDJ United, bet365 and PMU. **Regulation:** the base case is no new levy increase in the 2027 budget but a non-trivial (one-in-three) risk of either a further social-levy step or an extension of the 13.7% winnings levy to betting/lottery; the ANJ will tighten promotional-strategy approvals for 2027 (bonus volume ceilings, restrictions on bonuses to flagged players, event-period limits) and push adoption of its excessive-player algorithm with sanctions as the enforcement tool; online casino legalisation remains off the table until at least the PLF 2027 debate, with any eventual design favouring land-based licence holders. **Leverage/structure:** PMU's 'Pacte PMU 2030' and the −9.6% cut in racing funding make an increase in the racing companies' levy on online horse-race betting (by decree) more likely than any liberalisation; FDJ United's review of its online markets could bring portfolio sales but not a retreat from France. Net: France is a mature, slow-growing, high-tax market that rewards scale, CAC discipline and compliance capacity — attractive as a top-up for an established European operator, unattractive as a greenfield entry.

What to watch next quarter:

- PLFSS/PLF 2027 debates (autumn 2026 – early 2027): any change to the 15% social levy on online sports betting, the 10% poker levy, or extension of the 13.7% winnings levy to betting and lottery.
- ANJ FY2026 market review (~April 2027) and the H2 2026 retention of the 5.85m active accounts and 3.14m June monthly actives — the real World Cup ROI test; also FDJ United's Q3 revenue (21 Oct 2026) for the first read on post-tournament lottery and online trends.
- ANJ 2027 promotional-strategy approvals and any decree or guideline capping bonuses or restricting them to flagged players, following Decision 2026-118 (algorithm) and sanctions Decision 2026-031; further sanctions naming operators.
- Online casino: any restart of the Bercy consultation, publication of the IGF report, or a PLF 2027 amendment; land-based casino sector positioning.
- PMU 'Pacte PMU 2030' (governance under Giraudat/Woerth), the 2027 racing-funding budget and the annual decree setting the racing companies' levy on online horse-race betting.
- ANJ action on content: evolution of the authorised 'liste sport' after the Oct 2026 note on niche football leagues and excessive bettors; further blocking of prediction-market platforms.
- Licence cycle: new applications (post-bet365/Betsson/DAZN wave) and 2027 five-year renewals; any exits among smaller sports-only licensees under the 59.3% regime.

DATA CONFIDENCE: HIGH FX: EUR/USD 1.1212 as of 15 Oct 2026 (ANJ release date); all ~US$ figures converted at this rate. Market, segment, player and bonus figures are taken directly from the ANJ's H1 2026 report (text and OCR'd monthly annexes, which reconcile to reported totals: stakes €6,616.5m, GGR €995.2m, bonuses €128.9m) and the ANJ FY2025 review, cross-checked against FDJ United's H1 2026 release and the European Gaming article. Levy rates are from FDJ United's 2025 interim report/2025 outlook release and Légifrance snippets. Items NOT verified in this session and flagged in the text: the French state levy on poker stakes (post-2025 status), the land-based casino levy scale, payment-method shares, the 2023 influencer-law detail, the March 2026 IGF report on online casino, operator market shares (ANJ does not publish), the ~86,000 self-exclusion figure (OCR of ANJ brochure), and the implied tax-take figures (modelled estimates). H1 2025 comparatives are implied from ANJ growth rates and reflect the ANJ's 2025 perimeter restatement.

Sources: [Primary] ANJ – Bilan du marché des jeux d'argent au 1er semestre 2026 (press page, 15 Oct 2026); [Primary] ANJ – Analyse semestrielle des jeux d'argent et de hasard en France, premier semestre 2026 (PDF, 14 pp, incl. monthly annexes); [Primary] ANJ – Bilan 2025 du marché des jeux d'argent (16 Apr 2026): FY2025 market size, casinos, clubs, online data table; [Primary] ANJ – Opérateurs agréés (licensed operator register, consulted 19 Oct 2026); [Primary] ANJ – Décision n°2026-118: algorithme d'identification des joueurs excessifs ou pathologiques (26 May 2026); [Primary] ANJ – Commission des sanctions, Décision n°2026-031 (10 Jul 2026); [Primary] ANJ – Décision n°2026-016: plan d'actions jeu excessif 2026, Pari Mutuel Urbain; [Primary] ANJ – Plaquette institutionnelle 2025 (sites bloqués, fichier des interdits de jeux); [Primary] ANJ – Décision 2024-108, renouvellement d'agrément paris sportifs en ligne Zeturf (licence terms: 5 years, renewable, non-transferable); [Primary] ANJ – Décision 2025-125, renouvellement d'agrément paris sportifs en ligne PMU; [Primary] Légifrance – CGI art. 1012 (droit fixe dû par les opérateurs de jeux ou de paris en ligne); [Primary] Légifrance – CGI annexe III art. 313 BR–313 BRB (licence fee amounts); [Primary] Légifrance – CGI Section XI, prélèvements au profit de l'Agence nationale du sport (art. 1609 tricies: 6.6% retail / 10.6% online); [Primary] FDJ United – Résultats du 1er semestre 2026 (Business Wire, 29 Jul 2026); [Primary] FDJ United – Interim financial report 30 June 2025 (levy rates by vertical from 1 Jul 2025); [Primary] FDJ United – 2024 results / 2025 outlook affected by increased taxes (6 Mar 2025); [Primary] Assemblée nationale – amendement PLF n°2402 (13.7% levy on casino winnings >€1,500; proposed extension); [Secondary] European Gaming – French gambling growth slows to 0.5% in H1 2026, carried by online (19 Oct 2026); [Secondary] European Gaming – Europe gambling tax rates 2026 (France 59.3% breakdown); [Secondary] iGaming Business – FDJ expecting €45m impact from French gambling tax increases (Mar 2025); [Secondary] Le Monde du Tabac / Les Échos – alourdissement général de la fiscalité des jeux (Feb 2025); [Secondary] Altenar – Gambling laws & compliance in France: operator's guide (tax components); [Secondary] AFJEL – Baromètre sur l'offre illégale de jeux en ligne (5 Nov 2025) [industry lobby]; [Secondary] franceinfo – Casinos en ligne : le gouvernement suspend leur légalisation (Oct 2024); [Secondary] jouerenlignefr.org – Casinos en ligne en France : la légalisation reste suspendue (Apr 2026); [Secondary] jeuxcasino.com – Casino en ligne et budget 2027 : la loi dort mais le marché s'organise (Sep 2026); [Secondary] ClubPoker – L'algorithme de l'ANJ débarque (600,000 excessive players, May 2026); [Secondary] Gambling Insider – L'ANJ ordonne le blocage de Polymarket en France (Jul 2026); [Secondary] MercatoLive – L'ANJ obtient le blocage des sites Cbet et Stake (Jul 2026); [Secondary] Le Klub Extraordinaire – ANJ illegal-offer study figures (€748m–€1.5bn) and blocking powers since Mar 2022; [Secondary] exchange-rates.org – EUR/USD on 15 Oct 2026 (1 EUR = 1.1212 USD).

Research analysis only — not a rating, price target, or personalised investment advice. Prepared for internal executive review.